

SAMURAI CODE

Loyalty and honour were essential to the samurai. They lived by a strict, seven-point code called *Bushido*, which means "the way of the warrior".

GI	Integrity	JIN	Kindness
REI	Respect	MAKOTO	Sincerity
YU	Bravery	CHUGI	Loyalty
MEIYO	Honour		

WEAPONS AND ARMOUR

The samurais' favourite form of fighting was hand-to-hand combat with knives and swords. They were also expected to be skilled with bow and arrow, spears, and later, guns.



FACE PROTECTOR (MEMPO)



THROWING KNIFE



DAGGER (WAKIZASHI)



SWORD (KATANA)



GLAIVE (NAGINATA)

SPEAR

ART AND CRAFTS

In 1603 the city of Edo (now Tokyo) became the capital of Japan. In the 260 years of peace that followed, art and culture flourished as never before. Edo artists and craftsmen produced beautiful work, from delicate ivory carvings to bold, colourful paintings and prints showing city life.



WOODBLOCK PRINT OF EDO BY UTAGAWA HIROSHIGE 1857



BRASS LANTERN 18th century



WRESTLER'S NETSUKE 1800-50



CERAMIC INCENSE BURNER 1600-50



PRINTED FAN 1858



TEA KETTLE Edo period



PORCELAIN TEA BOWL 1700-50

MUSIC AND THEATRE

Going to the theatre and listening to music were popular pastimes for the wealthy. Noh theatre was a solemn form of storytelling, performed by actors in masks. Kabuki plays were much livelier and more dramatic.



KOTSUZIMI DRUM



NOTCH FLUTE



BAMBOO FLUTE



KABUKI ACTOR, EDO PERIOD



KOTO



SHAMISEN

ERAS AND EVENTS

Japan's Imperial Age began around 700 CE. Before then, the area was made of several smaller chiefdoms. The age effectively ended in 1868, when the modern era began. Japanese history is split into periods. A new period began at the start of the reign of a new emperor or with a similar major event.

1156 Civil war between several clans.



Woodblock print of Minamoto Tametomo fighting in the civil war

1192 After 30 years of civil war, Minamoto Yoritomo becomes shogun. The emperor's power is taken from him and he is reduced to a figurehead.

1281 Mongols attempting to invade Japan are forced back by a typhoon that the Japanese name *kamikaze*, or "divine wind".



Invading Mongols are forced back by a typhoon

1568 Oda Nobunaga seizes power in Kyoto. His army is equipped with muskets acquired from Portuguese traders.

c.1600 Art and culture flourish in the Edo period – beautiful objects are created by master craftsmen.



Folding war fan

1603 Shogun Ieyasu sets up his capital in a fishing town called Edo, which will become Tokyo.

1639 Foreigners are forced to leave, beginning a 220-year period of complete isolation for Japan.

700

2000

NARA
710-94
Periods of Japanese history are often named after the capital cities used by rulers of that period. The city of Nara is Japan's first permanent capital.

HEIAN
794-1185
Heian (now Kyoto) replaces Nara as Japan's capital in 794.

KAMAKURA
1185-1333
This period sees a huge rise in power of the daimyo and the samurai who serve them.

KENMU
1333-36
Brief restoration of rule by an emperor.

MUROMACHI
1336-1568
Also known as the Warring State period, this is a time of rebellion and unrest.

AZUCHI/MOMOYAMA
1568-1600
This period sees an end to the damaging internal conflicts the country has suffered.

EDO/TOKUGAWA
1600-1868
A long period of peace, during which Japan effectively cuts itself off from the rest of the world.

MEIJI
1868-1912

TAISHO
1912-26

SHOWA
1926-89

HEISEI
1989-